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Distinction between a Prophet and a Messenger & Blasphemy law in Pakistan

between a Prophet and a Messenger:

The famous distinctions between them are;

1. (A Messenger) is a male human being who receives revelation of the Shari'ah and he is ordered to preach it.
2. (A Prophet) is a male human who receives revelation of the Shari'ah although he is not ordered to preach it.

Nature of Prophet-hood:

- Prophet-hood is an honor from Allah, which He bestows upon whomsoever He pleases, as Allah says;
- اللَّهُ يُصْطَفِي مِنَ الْمَلَائِكَةِ رُسُلًا وَمِنَ النَّاسِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ سَمِيعٌ بَصِيرٌ
- "Allah chooses Messengers from angels and from men." [Surah al-Hajj (22): 75]. Prophet-hood is not something which can be acquired by the slave through struggle and exertions, performing different kinds of worships, engaging in tough exercises, persistently disciplining the soul or purification of the heart, refining the manners or spiritually exercising the soul - unlike what the philosophers claim. The philosophers claim that Prophet-hood can be achieved.

Blasphemy

- Blasphemy is the act of insulting or showing contempt or lack of reverence for a religious [deity](#) or the irreverence towards religious or holy persons or things. Some countries have laws to punish blasphemy, while others have laws to give recourse to those who are offended by blasphemy.

Blasphemy law in Pakistan:

- The [Pakistan Penal Code](#) prohibits [blasphemy](#) against any recognized religion, providing penalties ranging from a fine to death. Calls for change in the blasphemy laws have been strongly resisted by Islamic parties.
- 295 forbid damaging or defiling a place of worship or a sacred object.
- 295-A forbids outraging religious feelings.
- 295-B forbids defiling the Quran.
- 295-C forbids defaming the Prophet [Muhammad](#) SAW.

Internet Censorship

- In May 2010, Pakistan [blocked access to Facebook](#) because the website hosted a page called [Everybody Draw Muhammad Day](#). Pakistan lifted the block after Facebook prevented access to the page. In June 2010, Pakistan [blocked](#) seventeen websites for hosting content that the authorities considered offensive to Muslims. At the same time, Pakistan began to monitor the content of [Google](#), [Yahoo](#), YouTube, [Amazon](#), [MSN](#), [Hotmail](#), and [Bing](#).

Muhammad SAW and the West

- In contrast to the Islamic understanding of Muhammad, the Western image of him remained highly negative for over a millennium and has only recently begun to change.
- *Islam and the West by Dr. Philip K. Hitti*, 4th Chapter: Islam in western literature, 1962, USA.
- *The Image of the Muhammad in the West by Sayyed Hussein Nasr*, Encyclopedia Britannica.
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